

Instructions for writing the term paper.

Writing style:

- Clear sentences – pay attention to the structure of the text
- Paragraphs: one thought = one idea; use subsections in italic
- Follow journal style structure: Introduction. Literature background, Theory. Methods. Data, Measures, Results, Discussion
- Avoid passive and relative terms (could, might, maybe, etc.)
- References, substantiate your claims and analytical decisions

Presentation of results and methods:

- Never use screenshots, always provide proper tables/figures
- Labels in figures should be the same size as the main text
- Never describe variable names /how you loaded and manipulated the dataset, avoid technical details
- Avoid repetitions and separate clearly between results and methods sections.
- In results section: avoid post-hoc reasoning. Just describe the results.

Embedding in previous literature:

- In Introduction: what is the **contribution** of your study?
- Literature BG: what has been done so far?
- Methods/Measures: substantiate your analytical strategy
- Results: overlap/contrast with previous work?
- Discussion: what to do next? Target audience

Theory/ expectations:

- Where do your theoretical expectations come from? Derive Hypotheses based on past work.
- Why do you expect certain patterns in the data?

In general:

- Try to stay close to journal articles in tone, structure, and presentation of results
⇒ Take one article as a blueprint for your own study and emulate this article